



The Lake District

England's highest and arguably most picturesque region, a landscape shaped by glaciers and loved by tourists

The Lake District is a scenic area of mountains, moorlands, deep valleys, and lakes located within the county of Cumbria in northwest England. It contains most of the country's highest land, including Scafell Pike, its tallest peak, as well as England's longest and deepest lakes—Windermere and Wastwater, respectively. The region is named after the 16 lakes and many smaller water bodies, called tarns, which are found in higher areas. However, only one of the lakes, Bassenthwaite Lake, is actually called a lake; the others are known as waters or meres. Commonly defined by the boundary of the UK's largest national park, the Lake District covers an area of 912 square miles (2,362 square km).

Glacial landscape

The underlying geological structure of the Lake District is a huge granite dome, on top of which sits a series of three broad bands of rock of different ages and origins. Variations in bedrock can be seen in the different features across the region, from volcanic outcrops to slate scree slopes.

However, much of the landscape of the Lake District has been shaped by episodes of glaciation over the last 2 million years. Indeed, the region is known for its classic examples of glacial landforms. The most obvious of these are the broad valleys with their U-shaped cross sections, at the bottom of which often sit ribbon lakes.



△ QUEEN OF THE LAKES

Seen here with a cloud of mist hanging over it, Derwentwater is thought by many to be the most beautiful of the Lake District's lakes and is referred to as the Queen of the Lakes.



△ COMMON PREDATOR

The blue damselfly is a common predator on many UK waterways and large lakes. Unlike dragonflies, damselflies fold their wings along their body when resting.

The **Lake District National Park** is the **most visited** national park in the UK